Deploying a Zoho Creator Application from Development to Production

Aim

To understand the process of publishing and deploying a Zoho Creator application, ensuring that forms, reports, workflows, and user permissions are configured correctly before the application is shared with users.

Objectives

- To understand the difference between development and production environments.
- To learn how to publish a Zoho Creator application.
- To verify forms, reports, charts, and Deluge workflows before deployment.
- To understand how user roles and permissions are managed when sharing the application.
- To test the published application and ensure that its main features work correctly.

Prerequisites and Tools Required

- Zoho Creator account with the required permissions.

- Existing forms, reports, charts, and workflows.
- Internet connection and a web browser.
- Configured user roles, such as HR Administrator, Hiring Manager, and Interviewer.

Step-by-Step Implementation Procedure

Step 1: Pre-Deployment Verification

1. Log in to Zoho Creator.
2. Open the application in the builder.
3. Verify that the Job_Application_Form form is working correctly.
4. Open Candidate_Application_Report and confirm that candidate records are displayed.
5. Open Applications_Spreadsheet and verify the screening and interview details.
6. Check Department_Applications_Chart to confirm that department-wise application statistics are displayed.
7. Test the existing workflows and Deluge functions for errors.

8. Verify that the configured user roles and permissions are appropriate.

Step 2: Accessing the Publish or Deployment Options

1. Open the application in the Zoho Creator builder.
2. Look for the Publish, Share, or deployment options.
3. If separate development and production environments are available, open the environment management section.
4. Review the available publishing or deployment options.
5. If separate environments are unavailable, use the standard publishing or sharing option.

Step 3: Reviewing Application Components

1. Review the existing forms and fields.
2. Verify Job_Application_Form and its candidate information fields.
3. Check Candidate_Application_Report and Applications_Spreadsheet.
4. Verify Department_Applications_Chart and its data

source.

5. Review the configured workflows, schedules, functions, and approval processes.

6. Confirm that any required external connections are configured correctly.

7. Ensure that unnecessary test records and sensitive sample data are not exposed to users.

Step 4: Publishing the Application

1. Select the appropriate Publish option in Zoho Creator.

2. Review the available settings and access permissions.

3. Confirm the publishing action if prompted.

4. Wait for the publishing process to finish.

5. Open the published application using the available live application link.

6. Verify that the application opens correctly and that its forms and reports are accessible.

Step 5: Configuring User Access and Permissions

1. Open the application sharing or user permissions settings.
2. Verify the configured roles:
    - HR Administrator
    - Hiring Manager
    - Interviewer
3. Confirm that the intended users have been added and shared with the application.
4. Check the permissions assigned to each role.
5. Test access using the appropriate user accounts, where available.
6. Ensure that users can access only the forms, reports, and records permitted by their assigned permissions.

Step 6: Post-Deployment Testing

1. Open the published application.
2. Submit a sample candidate application, if permitted.

3. Verify that the submitted record appears in Candidate_Application_Report.

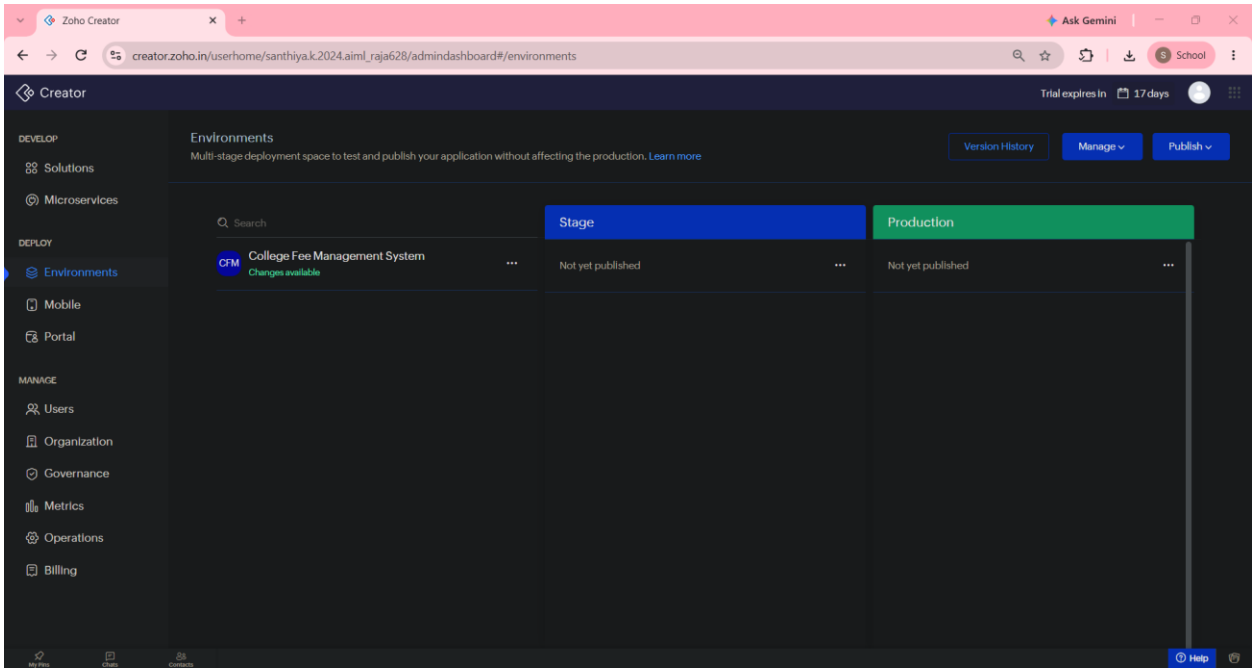
4. Check whether the department-wise chart displays the expected information.

5. Test the relevant workflows and functions.

6. Confirm that the configured user permissions work correctly.

7. Record any errors and correct them before operational use.

Screenshots



Result

The publishing and deployment process was studied. The forms, reports, charts, workflows, and user permissions were reviewed, and the published application was tested where the available Zoho Creator features permitted. This experiment demonstrated the importance of verifying application functionality and access permissions before making it available to users.